

Title: Wave management: When should I freeze vs shove

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Hey everyone,

I'm hovering around mid Platinum and still struggle with wave decisions after level 6.

I know the basics ? freeze when behind, shove when ahead for roams ? but in real games it feels more complex.

For example: If I have a small lead but enemy jungler is missing, is slow-pushing still safe?

Are there any advanced frameworks or questions you ask yourself to decide between shoving vs freezing?

Would love to hear your decision-making process in real time.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 47]

Those basics you stated are wrong depending on the champ .

On Darius it's way better to freeze when ahead so the enemy can't even get a single cs without me threatening an all-in.

On tryndamere if your behind is way better to shove into enemy tower followed by proxy

On Vlad mid vs a control mage it's better to shove into tower so the enemy had to focus on clearing the wave instead of poking you

Its all about the specific lane, your champ, and their champ. Look at high elo vods of your champ and see what those players do with the wave

[Comment 2 | Score: 10]

Why would you freeze when you're behind? You can't stop them from breaking your freeze. You should freeze when you're ahead so you can zone them away from any cs as you can safely protect the line of scrimmage.

You should not freeze when you're behind because they can freely push it and then tower dive you. Or if you die trying to protect the freeze, the wave is already at your tower and you lose everything.

[Comment 3 | Score: 4]

Freezing is used to deny CS/XP to your laner.

Shoving is used to free yourself up for map movement and often to deny more creeps.

You decide what you should do based on the mapstate and your gold. If you're sitting on a lot of gold or a critical item spike, push your lane out and reset. If your enemy laner just reset and has no TP or shows up in another lane, shove the lane and either get plates or reset for tempo. If there's an objective near you and your jungler is getting ready to start it, shove the lane and help them.

As for freezing, I typically freeze when I want to accelerate a lane lead while my laner is there or if I

want to turtle a bad matchup. If I can freeze early and deny XP to hit level 5-9 faster than the enemy, I usually will. If I can freeze the lane on my side in a losing matchup (like Kled v Fiora) I will because it introduces risk for my enemy laner. But beyond using freezes to reach those breakpoints (level spikes or items to neutralize a bad matchup), the returns start to diminish.

[Comment 4 | Score: 8]

?I know the basics ? freeze when behind, shove when ahead for roams?

This is why people are so bad and cannot improve

First of all that?s wrong, but the point is people just looking for the ?golden rules? or ?correct formula? for their game, rather than improve via understanding the game concepts

Freeze or shove ARE NOT depend on if you are a head or behind. Wave management (or any macro in the game) is about what you want on that moment.

And I very love it when people just follow youtube guide telling them ?always freeze the lane? and enjoy my free roam or recall.

Try to make plan, think ahead stop thinking ?oh do I want to push or freeze now?? (Noob way that ?youtube guide? trained you to think) look at objective, look at your other lanes, look at your Jungle, look at minimap. Now think, what do I want to do to push my or my team advantage. AND THEN after you got the answer, shoving or freezing?.

Tldr: Wave management is the answer to your macro/game plan, NOT the initial questions.

[Comment 5 | Score: 2]

Freezing is more so done to pull them towards you when your in a winning matchup. You basically try and either zone them from csing/getting xp or poke/all in if they come forward.